

INTRODUCTION TO SOCIOLOGY

(SOC1CJ101)

E Content

BA Sociology

Semester 1

Core Course

**Centre For Distance and Online
Education**

University of Calicut

Module 1
INTRODUCING SOCIOLOGY

Unit	Content
1	Origin and Development of Sociology
2	Sociology as a Science: Nature and Importance
3	Scope and Subject matter of Sociology
4	Branches of Sociology: Medical Sociology, Rural Sociology, Industrial Sociology, etc.
5	Applications of Sociology

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MODULE I

INTRODUCING SOCIOLOGY

Introduction to sociology is a foundation course of BA Sociology. It provides a very basic or primary idea about sociology to learners, its origin and development in world and the subject matter, nature, scope and uses. The module also gives a deep idea about the timely development and application of sociology in our daily life. The module familiarises various branches of sociology like medical sociology, industrial sociology, rural etc.

Chapter Outline

1. Origin and development of Sociology
2. Sociology as a science: Nature and Importance
3. Scope and subject matter of sociology
4. Branches of Sociology: Medical sociology, Rural sociology, Industrial sociology
5. Application of Sociology

Chapter objectives

The overall objective of the module is to provides a wide and deep knowledge about Sociology.

- a. The module caters the origin of sociology as an independent branch of knowledge.
- b. The module also gives an idea about the development of sociology.
- c. The module provides an idea about the subject matter, nature and scope of sociology
- d. The module supplies a knowledge about the newly developed branches of sociology and it also concentrates the application of sociology in our changing and developing contemporary societies.

Learning outcome

1. The learner will be able to define sociology.
2. The learner will be able explain sociology as a science.
3. The learner will be able to identify the application of sociology.

1.1 Origin and Development of sociology

- 1. The subtopic acquaints various forces which led to the origin of sociology as a branch of social science.**
- 2. The subtopic informs that the intellectual forces and social forces which contribute to the emergence of sociology.**
- 3. The subtopic educates learners the development of sociology as a branch of knowledge.**

Sociology is the scientific study of society. Society is constituted by different elements such as individuals, interaction, relationships, institutions, status, role, phenomena, etc. Various sociologists defined sociology differently, on the basis of their view on the subject matter. Auguste Comte, one of the major classical sociologists, popularly known as founding father of

sociology. Auguste Comte defines “sociology as the science of social phenomena subject to natural and invariable law, the discovery of which is the object of investigation.” Emile Durkheim another prominent French Sociologist and a well-known classical sociologist, who defines “Sociology as the science of social institution.” Max Weber is another classical sociologist and a prominent figure in German sociology, who defines “sociology as the science which attempts the interpretive understanding of social action in order thereby to arrive at a causal explanation of its course and effects.” These three sociologists differently define sociology, based on different areas of analysis such as social phenomena, social institution and social action. All these things included in society.

Sociology is the scientific study of society. The study of society is as old as human thought. However, the history of sociology as a discipline is just one hundred fifty years old. Before the emergence of sociology as an independent discipline the study of society had occurred on the basis of different perspectives like, religious, philosophical, historical, political and economic etc. Religion was based on the belief. Since ancient times, the religious laws influenced by every sphere of life like family, marriage, Kinship relation, social organization, customs, traditions etc., it followed for long period of time. This superstitious thinking is started to questioning and begins the influence of rational thought on the actions of people. Objectivity and detachment are the base of rationality, on the basis of these features man started to think about society. Before Christian Era, Greece, Rome, Arabia, China and India had developed a rich tradition of social philosophy. Some of the well-known philosophers of ancient time are Aristotle, Plato, Confucious, Kautilya and Manu. During ancient period man thought about social life by historical, political and economic perspectives. John Locks, Thomas Hobbes and Rousseau etc. are the major political thinkers, their contributions made foundation for the study of society. Sociology emerged in 18th century in France. The social, political, economic and intellectual background of 18th century had influenced the immediate origin of sociology as an independent discipline. The origin of sociology is shaped by various social, political, and intellectual forces. The next section discusses the social forces influence the emergence of sociology.

Social forces

Social forces refer to the major social changes, conditions, and processes that influenced the emergence and development of sociology as a separate academic discipline. These forces arise from society itself and shape human behaviour, social relationships, and institutions. In the

context of the development of sociology, social forces mainly include large-scale transformations such as the growth of cities, changes in family structure, class divisions, population increase, and social problems like poverty and inequality. These changes created a need to systematically study society. Industrial revolution is the major social force influence the emergence of sociology.

Industrial Revolution

Industrial revolution is the major social force, which influenced the origin and development of sociology. The Industrial Revolution first occurred in United Kingdom in the 18th century, and later spread to other parts of Europe and America. The United Kingdom (UK) is a sovereign state located in northwestern Europe, comprising England, Scotland, Wales, and Northern Ireland. The Industrial Revolution refers to the transformation from an agrarian (agriculture-based) society to an industrial (machine-based) society. It began with the introduction of machines, factories, and new methods of production. Production shifted from small-scale handwork at home to large-scale factory production. This brought rapid economic and social changes. The Industrial Revolution created major changes in society. It led to urbanisation, migration from villages to cities, the growth of factories, changes in family structure, and new social classes such as the industrial working class and capitalist class. It also created social problems like poverty, unemployment, poor working conditions, slums, and increased crime. These rapid and large-scale changes created a need to study society scientifically. Scholars felt the necessity to understand social order, social change, and social problems in a systematic way. This situation contributed to the emergence of sociology as an independent branch of knowledge. The Industrial Revolution brought significant changes in social and economic life. It led to the growth of industries and factories, which transformed traditional agrarian societies into industrial societies. As a result, large-scale urbanisation and migration from rural to urban areas took place. These changes created several social problems, such as overcrowding, unemployment, poor housing conditions, the growth of slums, and increasing crime. Both rural and urban areas experienced serious social disorganization. These rapid social changes created a need to study society in a systematic and scientific manner. This situation played an important role in the emergence of sociology as an independent discipline. Industrial revolution brings various social changes such as urbanization, migration, changes in family structure and the emergence of new class, these points briefly explain below:

1. Urbanization

Urbanisation refers to the process by which a large number of people move from rural areas to urban areas, leading to the growth and expansion of towns and cities. It also refers to the increase in the proportion of population living in urban areas. Urbanisation is closely connected with industrialization, as the growth of industries creates employment opportunities in cities, attracting rural populations. Urbanisation brings changes in social life, family structure, occupation, lifestyle, and social relationships. It may also lead to problems such as overcrowding, slums, unemployment, and crime. Urbanisation, which developed rapidly after the Industrial Revolution, was closely analysed by major classical sociologists. They studied urban growth and its effects on social life, which helped in establishing sociology as an independent discipline. Karl Marx, Emile Durkheim, Max Weber and Georg Simmel etc. are the major classical sociologists analysed urbanization. Marx examined the growth of industrial cities and the migration of workers from rural to urban areas. He analysed how urbanisation led to the development of capitalism, class division, and class conflict between the bourgeoisie and the proletariat. Durkheim studied the effects of increasing population density and division of labour in urban areas. He explained how urbanisation contributed to the shift from mechanical solidarity to organic solidarity and sometimes led to social problems like anomie. Weber analysed the growth of modern cities, rationalization, and bureaucracy. He studied the development of urban centres in relation to economic and political organization. Simmel examined the psychological and social impact of city life. He explained how urban life affects individual behaviour, social relationships, and mental attitudes.

Marx, Durkheim, Weber, and Simmel are the major classical sociologists who analysed urbanisation. Their studies of urban society contributed significantly to the emergence and development of sociology as an independent field of knowledge.

2. Migration

Migration is another important social factor that resulted from the Industrial Revolution. Migration is the movement of people, permanently or temporarily from place of origin to place of destination. Migration can take place from rural to urban areas, from one region to another, or even from one country to another. The Industrial Revolution led to the establishment of factories and industries mainly in urban areas. These industries required a large labour force. As a result, many people moved from villages to cities in search of employment and better living conditions. This large-scale rural-to-urban migration changed the population structure of cities and contributed to rapid urban growth.

Migration also brought social changes such as the breakdown of traditional joint family systems, the emergence of nuclear families, changes in occupation, and the development of new social classes. At the same time, it created social problems like overcrowding, slums, unemployment, and increased crime. Karl Marx, Emile Durkheim and Max Weber are the major classical sociologists analysed migration. Karl Marx analysed the migration of workers to industrial cities and explained how capitalism created a working-class dependent on wages. Emile Durkheim studied population growth and division of labour, which were closely related to migration and urban expansion. Max Weber examined the development of modern industrial society and the movement of people in relation to economic opportunities and rational organization.

Migration was a major social change brought about by industrialization. The study of migration and its consequences helped sociologists understand social change, social structure, and social problems, thereby contributing to the development of sociology as an independent branch of knowledge.

3. Changes in family structure

Before industrialization, most families were joint or extended families and were mainly engaged in agricultural work. The family functioned as a unit of production, education, and socialization. With the growth of industries and urbanisation, several changes took place such as the joint family system gradually weakened, and the nuclear family became more common. Production shifted from home to factory, reducing the economic role of the family. Family members began to work outside the home for wages. There was a decline in the authority of elders and the patriarchal system in some societies. Marriage, gender roles, and parent-child relationships also experienced changes. Thus, the Industrial Revolution transformed the structure and functions of the family. Several classical and early sociologists studied family and social structure, which contributed to the foundation of sociology. Karl Marx analysed the family in relation to private property and capitalism. He explained how economic changes influenced family structure. Friedrich Engels, in his work *The Origin of the Family, Private Property and the State*, examined the historical development of the family and linked it to economic systems. Émile Durkheim studied the functions of the family and its role in maintaining social order and moral regulation. Max Weber analysed family structure in relation to authority, religion, and social status. Herbert Spencer examined the evolution of family forms from simple to complex societies. Changes in family structure were an important

outcome of industrialization. The study of family and social structure by classical sociologists played a significant role in the development of sociology as an independent discipline.

4. Emergence of new classes

Class is a basic concept in sociology. It is a form of social stratification in which individuals or groups are categorized based on factors such as income, occupation, education, wealth, and power. The Industrial Revolution refers to the process of transformation in modern history from an agrarian and handicraft-based economy to one dominated by industry and machine manufacturing. This major economic change led to the formation of new social classes in society. Industrial capitalism was the major economic system during the period of the Industrial Revolution. Many institutions and sectors such as banking, trade, hospitals, courts, and business developed significantly during this period. The dominant class in this period was the industrial elite or capitalists. This class consisted of wealthy bankers, capitalists, and industrialists. Another important class that emerged during this period was the educated middle class, also known as the professional bourgeoisie. This class included professionals such as engineers, technicians, doctors, and lawyers. In addition, there was the working class, which consisted mainly of labourers who migrated to urban areas in search of employment in factories, mines, and dockyards. The emergence of new social classes during the Industrial Revolution was mainly analysed by the following sociologists:

Karl Marx explains the emergence of two major classes in capitalist society such as the bourgeoisie (capitalist class) who own the means of production, and the proletariat (working class) who sell their labour for wages. He emphasized class conflict between these two classes. Max Weber analysed social stratification in terms of class, status, and power. Weber argued that economic position, social prestige, and political power together shape social class in modern industrial society. Émile Durkheim studied the changes brought by industrialization and explained how the division of labour in modern industrial society led to new occupational groups and social differentiation.

These sociologists played a major role in analysing the emergence of new classes and social stratification during the Industrial Revolution. All of these sociologists conceptualised class as a group or stratification system. Marx analysed in terms of the ownership of means of production, Weber analysed class in modern industrial society, Durkheim analysed class as an occupational group.

5. Rise of various social problems

Various social problems such as slums, increased crime, poverty, unemployment etc. are result of rapid industrialisation and urbanization. The growth of these social issues attracted the attention of early thinkers and scholars. As a result, the systematic study of these problems contributed significantly to the emergence and development of sociology. Various conditions such as Introduction of Machines, decline of cottage industries, migration to cities, irregular industrial employment produced unemployment. Introduction of machines during the industrial revolution, machines replaced many manual jobs. As a result, many artisans and handicraft workers lost their traditional occupations. Thus, unemployment became a major social problem during the Industrial Revolution and attracted the attention of early sociologists. Several early sociologists were strongly attracted by the social problems created during the Industrial Revolution, such as poverty, unemployment, poor working conditions, and urban slums. The major sociologists who studied these problems include Karl Marx – He analysed the problems created by capitalism and industrialization, especially the exploitation of the working class and the conflict between the bourgeoisie and the proletariat. Friedrich Engels another notable philosopher studied the miserable living and working conditions of workers in industrial cities and described them in his famous book ‘The Condition of the Working Class in England’. Émile Durkheim examined the social changes caused by industrialization and focused on issues such as social disorder, anomie, and the need for social solidarity. Max Weber analysed the development of modern industrial society, bureaucracy, capitalism, and the social inequalities that emerged during this period. These sociologists played an important role in studying and explaining the social problems that emerged during the Industrial Revolution, which contributed to the development of sociology as a scientific discipline. The destruction of the agrarian social structure and the emergence of urban society were other important social changes produced by the Industrial Revolution that led to the emergence of sociology. These rapid social transformations attracted the attention of several sociologists, such as Auguste Comte, Karl Marx, Émile Durkheim, and Max Weber, who attempted to study and explain the changes taking place in modern industrial society.

Political forces

Political forces refer to the major political events, ideas, and changes in governance that influenced the emergence and growth of sociology as a distinct academic discipline. These forces arise from changes in political systems, power structures, laws, and ideologies. In the development of sociology, political forces include revolutions, the rise of modern nation-states,

democratic ideas, and changes in authority and governance. These transformations created new questions about social order, rights, equality, and the role of the state.

The major political force contributed to the emergence of sociology is French revolution 1789. This revolution was not confined only to French society; its influence spread throughout Europe and affected many societies. The revolution began in 1789 and was mainly directed against the existing political administration and the absolute rule of the monarchy. It challenged the traditional political system and demanded political rights and equality for the people. Thus, the French Revolution became an important political event that brought major social and political changes, which later influenced the emergence of sociology. The French Revolution of 1789 was the first major modern and ideological revolution in Europe. It destroyed the feudal social system and challenged the authority of the monarchy, aristocracy, and the Church. French revolution destroyed feudal social system. In the pre-revolutionary period, French society was organized under a feudal social system. This system created deep social inequality and dissatisfaction, which eventually led to the French Revolution of 1789. Under the feudal system, society was divided into three main estates: the clergy (First Estate), the nobility (Second Estate), and the common people or peasants (Third Estate). The clergy and nobility enjoyed many privileges such as exemption from most taxes, ownership of large lands, and political power. In contrast, the Third Estate, which included peasants, workers, and the middle class, had to bear heavy taxes and feudal obligations. They had very little political power and were often exploited by the ruling classes. This unequal social structure created economic hardship, social injustice, and political dissatisfaction among the common people. As a result, people began to oppose the feudal system and demand equality and political rights.

Thus, the feudal social system in pre-revolutionary France created inequality and oppression, which became one of the major causes that led to the outbreak of the French Revolution in 1789. For the first time, people began to see themselves as citizens who possessed certain rights and duties.

Rise of new ideologies

French revolution introduced important ideas such as liberty, equality, and fraternity, which fundamentally altered social, political, and economic structures. Besides these, other new ideas such as individualism, democracy and secularism emerged with French revolution. These ideas also known as enlightenment ideas. It also led to the adoption of the Declaration of the Rights of Man and of the Citizen, which emphasized individual rights and equality before the law.

Many traditional social institutions were changed. Civil marriage and divorce were introduced, and reforms were made in education and religion. Then we will discuss these new ideas in detail:

Individualism

Individualism emphasizes the importance and value of the individual in society. Before the Revolution, people were mainly identified by their social class, such as clergy, nobility, or peasants. The Revolution promoted the idea that every individual has personal rights and freedoms. It stressed that individuals should be treated as independent persons with equal dignity and opportunities, rather than being judged by their birth or social status.

Liberty

Liberty means freedom from oppression and arbitrary authority (It refers to a situation where a ruler or authority makes decisions based on personal will or desire rather than established laws or democratic principles). The Revolution demanded freedom of speech, freedom of thought, freedom of religion, and freedom from unjust rule. It opposed the absolute power of the monarchy and supported the idea that people should have the freedom to express their opinions and participate in political life.

Equality

Equality refers to the idea that all citizens are equal before the law. Under the old feudal system, society was divided into estates with unequal privileges. The Revolution abolished these privileges and declared that everyone should have equal legal rights, equal opportunities, and equal treatment by the government regardless of their social background.

Fraternity

Fraternity means a sense of brotherhood and solidarity among citizens. The Revolution encouraged people to see each other as members of a single nation rather than as separate classes. It promoted unity, cooperation, and mutual support among people for the welfare of society.

Democracy

Democracy refers to a political system in which power belongs to the people. The Revolution challenged the rule of kings and promoted the idea that government should be based on the will

of the people. Citizens should have the right to elect their representatives and participate in the political decision-making process.

Secularism:

Secularism means the separation of religion from the affairs of the state. Before the Revolution, the church had strong control over political and social life. The Revolution reduced the power of the church and emphasized that the government should remain neutral in matters of religion and treat all religions equally.

Thus, the French Revolution played a crucial role in spreading modern political ideals such as liberty, equality, fraternity, democracy, secularism, and individual rights. These principles later influenced many political movements and contributed to the development of modern sociology and democratic societies.

Early sociologists closely analysed the new ideas that emerged from the French Revolution, such as democracy, secularism, individualism, liberty, fraternity, and equality. They tried to understand how these new principles transformed social structure, social relations, and political systems. Some important sociologists and their analyses are given below.:

Auguste Comte viewed the social changes after the Revolution as a period of disorder and instability. According to him, the revolutionary ideas destroyed the traditional institutions such as monarchy and church, which created social chaos. He believed society needed a new scientific approach to restore order. This idea led him to develop sociology as a science to study society and guide social reconstruction. Saint-Simon, was a French social thinker and early socialist philosopher. Saint-Simon supported many ideals of the Revolution such as equality and social progress. He believed that society should be organized on the basis of ability and productivity rather than hereditary privilege. He also emphasized the role of science and industry in building a new, more equal society. Emile Durkheim analysed the rise of individualism and the weakening of traditional authority. He argued that modern societies are based on organic solidarity, where social unity comes from the interdependence of individuals. He believed that democratic values and individual rights must be balanced with social integration to maintain social order. Alexis de Tocqueville carefully studied democracy and its impact on society. He believed that democracy promotes equality and political participation, but it may also create risks such as the “tyranny of the majority.” His work explained how democratic values influence social relations and political institutions. Karl Marx critically analysed the revolutionary ideals of liberty and equality. He argued that although political

equality was proclaimed, economic inequality still existed under capitalism. According to him, real freedom and equality could only be achieved through the abolition of class exploitation.

Thus, early sociologists examined the new ideas of democracy, liberty, equality, fraternity, secularism, and individualism from different perspectives. Their analyses helped in understanding the social changes produced by the French Revolution and contributed to the development of sociology as a scientific study of society.

The system of monarchy in France was another cause of French revolution. Monarchy is a form of government in which supreme political power is held by a king or queen. In this system, the ruler usually gets power through heredity, and the authority is often absolute, meaning the ruler has very strong control over administration, law, and decision-making. Before the French Revolution of 1789, France was ruled by an absolute monarchy under kings such as Louis XVI. The king possessed extensive powers and the people had very little participation in government.

The monarchical system led to the French Revolution in several ways such as Concentration of power (Political power was concentrated in the hands of the king, and common people had no role in governance), financial crisis and heavy taxation (The monarchy imposed heavy taxes mainly on the common people while the nobility and clergy enjoyed privileges), administrative inefficiency (Poor financial management and expensive royal lifestyles created economic problems in the country), public dissatisfaction – The people became dissatisfied with the unfair political system and demanded equality, rights, and representation. Due to these problems, people began to oppose the absolute monarchy, which finally contributed to the outbreak of the French Revolution in 1789. Although the revolution promised freedom and social progress, it also created instability, violence, and uncertainty in society.

French revolution was not merely the overturn of administration; it is the beginning of a long series of political revolutions ushered in by the French revolution in 1789 and carrying over through the 19th century. In pre-revolution period, the society in France and Europe was characterized by a rigid social hierarchy, with the aristocracy and clergy holding the most power and influence. The revolution, which began in 1789, aimed to challenge and overthrow this hierarchical structure, leading to a reorganization of society and the rise of new social classes. One of the key factors that contributed to the emergence of sociology was the breakdown of traditional social order during the revolution. The revolution brought about sweeping political, economic, and social changes that disrupted existing social structures and

norms. The overthrow of the monarchy, the dissolution of feudal privileges, and the redistribution of land fundamentally altered the social fabric of French society. This upheaval created a need to understand and analyse the emerging social conditions and dynamics. The French Revolution also sparked intellectual debates and discussions about the nature of society and social change. Scholars and thinkers began to question the existing social order and sought to understand the underlying causes and consequences of the revolution. They examined issues such as inequality, social mobility, power dynamics, and the relationship between individuals and society. The political background of the society was very weak during this period. The specific political background leading to the overthrow of French administration, for that French revolution broke out. During that term French society was divided into three estates. The first estate was constituted by clergy, it is not merely a single group, which included bishops, priest and other religious officials enjoyed significant changes and were exempt from taxation. The second estate was another category of people, that group is constituted by the nobility, which composed by aristocrats and members of royal family, they too were exempted from paying taxes. Third estate is another category, which was formed by the vast majority of population. The third estate composed by bourgeoisie, urban workers and peasants. This administrative disorder not confine in administrative sector, its reflections create more and more problems in life of people and society. The disorder created by French revolution attracted the attention of French social thinkers. Saint Simon, Auguste Comte etc. are the major thinkers analysed the French society and put forwarded various ways to restore that order in Middle Era. Industrial revolution is an economic change stir up the European society, even though, it is an economic change it made changes in all spheres of life like social, religious, etc. Industrial revolution means the large-scale mechanisation in production. It opens new vistas of occupation. It also rises the rate of rural to urban and urban to urban migration; which accelerates the urban problems like poverty, crime, juvenile delinquency, slum creations etc. These problems attracted the attention of various social philosophers like Simmel, Saint Simon, Karl Marx etc. Industrial revolution also produced capitalism and philosophers put forwarded socialism as a solution of the problem created by capitalism.

Intellectual forces

Intellectual forces refer to the ideas, philosophies, and ways of thinking developed by scholars that influenced the emergence of sociology as a separate scientific discipline. These forces arise from the growth of knowledge and critical thinking about society. In the development of

sociology, intellectual forces include the rise of rational thinking, scientific methods, and new philosophical ideas about society and human behaviour. Thinkers began to move away from religious and traditional explanations and started explaining social life through reason and observation. Renaissance and enlightenment are the major intellectual forces influence the emergence of sociology. Renaissance is an intellectual force influences the origin of sociology in world. It is an epoch of unparalleled cultural and intellectual ferment that unfolded across the 14th and 17th centuries in Europe that marked a transition from Middle Ages to modernity. It is a period of revolutionary change in art, architecture, poetry, writings etc. Humanism is a perspective emerged during renaissance period in the field of knowledge. It believed in the human power to do and determine the course of social action and it undermined the theological world view fostered by Church.

Renaissance

Renaissance is considered another important intellectual force that contributed to the emergence of sociology. The Renaissance refers to the revival of learning, art, science, and intellectual thinking in Europe between the 14th and 17th centuries. The word Renaissance means “rebirth.” It marked the rebirth of interest in classical knowledge, human reasoning, and scientific inquiry. During the medieval period, intellectual life was largely controlled by the church, and most explanations about society and the world were based on religious doctrines. The Renaissance brought a major change by encouraging humanism, rational thinking, and scientific curiosity.

Scholars began to study human life, society, history, and culture from a secular and rational perspective rather than relying only on religious explanations. This shift encouraged people to observe reality, question traditions, and develop new knowledge. The Renaissance also promoted the development of science, literature, philosophy, and education, which created a new intellectual environment. Thinkers and scientists such as Galileo Galilei and Leonardo da Vinci demonstrated the importance of observation and scientific inquiry.

These intellectual developments gradually encouraged scholars to study human society in a systematic and rational way. This intellectual climate later influenced thinkers like Auguste Comte, who established sociology as a scientific study of society. The Renaissance encouraged humanism, individualism, scientific thinking, secularism, empirical evidences and critical inquiry, which helped create the intellectual foundation for the emergence of sociology.

Humanism

Humanism was one of the most important intellectual ideas that developed during the Renaissance. It is a philosophy that emphasizes the value, dignity, and potential of human beings. Humanism encouraged people to focus on human life, human achievements, and human reasoning rather than concentrating only on religious doctrines.

During the medieval period, intellectual life was largely dominated by the church, and most knowledge was centered on theology and religious teachings. The Renaissance humanists challenged this tradition and promoted the study of classical Greek and Roman literature, philosophy, history, and arts. They believed that studying classical texts would help people develop wisdom, moral values, and critical thinking.

Humanists argued that human beings have the ability to think rationally, create knowledge, and shape their own destiny. They emphasized the importance of education, intellectual freedom, and individual development. As a result, subjects such as literature, history, philosophy, and arts gained importance in education. Important humanist scholars such as Francesco Petrarch and Desiderius Erasmus promoted the study of classical works and encouraged intellectual curiosity. Francesco Petrarch was an Italian scholar, considered as the “Father of Humanism,” he fused Christian thought with Greco-Roman ideals and shaped modern humanist philosophy. Desiderius Erasmus was a Dutch Renaissance humanist, theologian, and scholar whose writings shaped European intellectual life in the early 16th century. He was a leading figure of northern humanism

The humanist emphasis on human reasoning, critical inquiry, and the study of human society later helped create the intellectual environment for the development of modern social sciences, including sociology. Humanism was a Renaissance idea that focused on human dignity, rational thinking, and education, which encouraged scholars to study human life and society more systematically.

Individualism

Individualism is a philosophy that emphasizes the importance, freedom, and autonomy of the individual. It argues that each person has the right to think independently, make personal choices, and develop their own abilities without excessive control from society, the state, or traditional authorities. This idea became especially prominent during the Renaissance and later the Enlightenment, when thinkers began to stress human dignity, personal freedom, and rational thinking.

Philosophers such as John Locke argued that individuals possess natural rights like life, liberty, and property. These ideas strengthened the philosophical foundation of individualism. During the medieval period, society emphasized collective identity where people were expected to follow the authority of the church, feudal lords, and traditional institutions. Individual freedom and personal achievements were not given much importance. The Renaissance changed this outlook by emphasizing the importance of the individual person. Thinkers and scholars believed that every individual has the capacity for creativity, reasoning, and self-development. People were encouraged to express their talents in fields such as art, literature, science, and philosophy. Renaissance artists and thinkers such as Leonardo da Vinci and Michelangelo became famous for their individual talents and achievements, which reflected the spirit of individualism.

Scientific thinking

The Renaissance encouraged the development of scientific thinking, which means understanding the world through observation, experimentation, and logical reasoning. During this period, scholars began to move away from explanations based only on religious beliefs and traditional authority and started to study nature and society through systematic investigation.

In the medieval period, knowledge was largely controlled by the church, and scientific inquiry was limited. The Renaissance changed this situation by encouraging scholars to observe natural phenomena, question existing beliefs, and seek evidence-based explanations.

Secularism

One of the important ideas promoted during the Renaissance was secularism. Secularism refers to the idea that social, political, and intellectual life should not be completely controlled by religious authority. It encourages people to view the world from a non-religious or worldly perspective. During the medieval period, the church had great influence over education, politics, and social life. Most knowledge and explanations about the world were based on religious teachings. The Renaissance gradually changed this situation by encouraging scholars to study subjects such as art, literature, science, and history independently of religious control. Renaissance thinkers believed that human life, culture, and society could be studied through reason and observation, not only through religious doctrines.

Empirical evidences

One important idea encouraged during the Renaissance was the importance of empirical evidence. It is closely related with empiricism. Empiricism is a philosophical movement during the early modern period, which developed mainly during the 17th and 18th centuries in Europe. Francis Bacon, John Locke and David Hume are the major empiricist philosophers.

During the medieval period, knowledge was often based on religious doctrines and traditional authority. Scholars usually accepted explanations given by the church without questioning them. The Renaissance brought a change by encouraging scholars to observe nature carefully and collect factual evidence before making conclusions. Renaissance thinkers believed that true knowledge should come from practical observation and real-world experience.

Critical enquiry

One of the important intellectual ideas promoted during the Renaissance was critical thinking. Critical thinking means the ability to question, analyse, and evaluate ideas using reason and evidence instead of accepting them blindly. During the medieval period, knowledge and beliefs were largely controlled by the church and traditional authorities. People were generally expected to accept religious teachings and social traditions without questioning them. The Renaissance challenged this situation by encouraging scholars to examine ideas independently and think rationally. Renaissance scholars began to question traditional beliefs, analyse classical texts, and seek logical explanations for natural and social phenomena. Renaissance played a significant role in creating the intellectual environment that led to the emergence of sociology. By promoting ideas such as humanism, individualism, scientific thinking, secularism, empirical evidence, and critical inquiry, it encouraged people to study society using reason and observation. These developments later influenced thinkers such as Auguste Comte, who established sociology as the scientific study of society. Sociology is the scientific study of society, which is constituted by social interaction, social relationship, social institutions, social life, social group etc. Sociology originated in 19th century in USA.

Enlightenment

Enlightenment is another intellectual force influence the origin of sociology. It was a period of remarkable intellectual development and change in the philosophical thought. A number of long-standing ideas and belief – many of which related to social life – were overthrown and replaced during the enlightenment. Enlightenment is the age of reason. The Enlightenment refers to an intellectual movement in Europe during the 17th and 18th centuries that emphasized reason, scientific thinking, and critical examination of traditional beliefs.

Enlightenment is the rise of rational and scientific thinking about society. It encouraged scholars to question traditional authorities such as the church and monarchy and to understand social life through reason, observation, and scientific methods. Major thinkers in Enlightenment period are Montesquieu, Rousseau, Descartes, Hobbes, John Locke etc. All of them analysed human society on the basis of rational and empirical perspective. Enlightenment thinkers produced traditional ideas and institutions as irrational and these will hinder the human growth and development. Scientific thinking is the speciality of Renaissance and enlightenment. There was an increased emphasis on science in society as a whole. The impact of the scientific revolution was crucial not just in changing material life but also on ideas about nature and society. Newton developed the theory of gravity in the field of physics, which provides a base for the study of physical science, like that social philosophers arranged social science after physical science and began to frame the statement as like gravity theory. Scientific thinking mainly based on rationality and empiricism. All knowledges are based on reason. Comte given the name *Social physics* in 1839 to the specific branch of knowledge. The following points can be included in enlightenment: Emphasis on Reason and Rational Thinking, Criticism of Traditional Authority, Belief in Scientific Method, Idea of Social Progress, Development of Individual Rights, and Encouragement of Critical and Analytical Thinking.

Emphasis on Reason and Rational Thinking

During the Enlightenment, thinkers argued that society should be understood through human reason, logic, and critical thinking rather than depending only on religious beliefs, customs, or traditional authority.

Before the Enlightenment, most explanations about society, social order, and human behaviour were based mainly on religion and long-standing traditions. People believed that social institutions such as monarchy, class hierarchy, and church authority were divinely ordained and should not be questioned. As a result, individuals rarely analysed social problems rationally.

Enlightenment thinkers challenged this approach. They believed that human beings have the capacity to think rationally and scientifically. According to them, social institutions, laws, and customs should be examined through reason and evidence. If certain traditions or institutions were unjust or irrational, they should be questioned and reformed. For example, thinkers like John Locke, Jean-Jacques Rousseau, and Montesquieu argued that society and government

should be based on rational principles, justice, and the rights of individuals, rather than blind obedience to tradition or religious authority.

This new emphasis on reason, observation, and critical analysis later influenced early sociologists such as Auguste Comte to study society scientifically and systematically, which contributed to the emergence of sociology as a discipline. The Enlightenment promoted the idea that society can be understood and improved by using human reason and scientific thinking instead of relying only on religion and tradition.

Criticism of Traditional Authority

During the Enlightenment, many thinkers began to criticize traditional authorities such as the monarchy, the church, and the feudal social system. Before this period, these institutions had absolute power and influence, and people were generally expected to obey them without questioning.

The monarchy claimed that the king ruled by divine right, meaning that the king's authority came directly from God. Similarly, the church controlled many aspects of social life, education, and moral values. The feudal system also created a rigid hierarchy where nobles and landlords had privileges, while peasants had very few rights. Enlightenment thinkers argued that these institutions should not be accepted blindly. Instead, they believed that people should critically examine whether these authorities were just, rational, and beneficial for society. They encouraged individuals to question unfair laws, social inequalities, and oppressive power structures.

For example, Montesquieu criticized absolute monarchy and proposed the idea of separation of powers in government. Jean-Jacques Rousseau argued that political authority should come from the general will of the people, not from kings or aristocrats.

This critical attitude toward traditional authority encouraged scholars to analyse social institutions objectively and scientifically, which later influenced early sociologists such as Auguste Comte to study society in a systematic way.

The Enlightenment encouraged people to question and critically examine traditional authorities like monarchy, church, and feudal institutions, instead of accepting them blindly. This spirit of critical inquiry helped create the intellectual foundation for the development of sociology.

Belief in Scientific Method

During the Enlightenment, thinkers strongly believed that knowledge should be based on scientific methods rather than on superstition, blind faith, or traditional beliefs. They argued that truth can be discovered through observation, experimentation, and logical reasoning.

In natural sciences, scientists like Isaac Newton showed that the physical world operates according to natural laws that can be discovered through scientific investigation. Enlightenment thinkers believed that similar methods could also be used to understand human society and social behaviour. According to this view, social phenomena such as social order, inequality, crime, family structure, and social change should be studied through systematic observation, collection of facts, and careful analysis. Instead of relying on myths or religious explanations, scholars began to search for scientific explanations of social life. This idea greatly influenced early sociologists, especially Auguste Comte, who proposed that society should be studied using the scientific method, just like the natural sciences. He called this approach Positivism, which emphasizes observation, comparison, and empirical research.

Positivism

It is a philosophical and scientific approach developed in the early 19th century, mainly between the 1820s and 1840s, by Auguste Comte. It states that society should be studied using scientific methods such as observation, experimentation, and comparison, similar to the methods used in natural sciences. Comte introduced the idea of positivism in his famous work *The Course of Positive Philosophy*, published between 1830 and 1842.

Idea of Social Progress

During the Enlightenment, many thinkers believed that human society is not fixed or unchangeable. Instead, they argued that society can develop, improve, and progress over time through the use of knowledge, education, science, and rational thinking. This belief is known as the idea of social progress.

Before this period, many people believed that social conditions such as poverty, inequality, and political authority were part of a natural or divine order and could not be changed. Enlightenment thinkers challenged this belief. They argued that if people gain knowledge and use reason, they can reform social institutions and improve society. For example, through education and scientific knowledge, individuals become more aware of their rights and responsibilities. This awareness encourages them to question unjust practices and work for

social reforms. Enlightenment thinkers believed that rational laws, better education, and fair political systems could create a more just and progressive society. This belief in progress influenced early sociologists such as Auguste Comte, who argued that society develops through different stages of intellectual growth. Comte explained this idea through the Law of Three Stages, which suggests that human thought and society progress from theological stage to metaphysical stage and finally to the positive (scientific) stage.

The idea of social progress means that society can become better and more advanced through knowledge, education, scientific thinking, and rational reforms. This belief encouraged scholars to study society scientifically, which contributed to the development of sociology.

The Enlightenment promoted the belief that scientific methods such as observation and logical analysis should be used to study society, and this idea later became an important foundation for sociological research.

Development of individual rights

During the Enlightenment, thinkers strongly emphasized the importance of individual rights and freedoms. They argued that every human being has certain natural rights, and these rights should be protected by society and the government. Before this period, society was largely controlled by monarchies, feudal systems, and the church, where individuals had very limited rights. Social hierarchy was rigid, and people were often expected to obey authority without questioning. Enlightenment thinkers challenged this system and argued that all individuals are equal by nature and deserve freedom and justice. Thinkers such as John Locke argued that individuals possess natural rights such as life, liberty, and property. Similarly, Jean-Jacques Rousseau emphasized the idea that political authority should be based on the will of the people rather than the absolute power of rulers. These ideas promoted important values such as liberty (freedom), equality, and individual rights. They also influenced major political and social transformations such as the French Revolution, which demanded liberty, equality, and fraternity. Later, these ideas became important themes in sociology. Sociologists began to study social inequality, individual freedom, social justice, and the relationship between individuals and society. The Enlightenment promoted the idea that all individuals have equal rights and freedoms, and this emphasis on liberty and equality became an important foundation for sociological thinking.

Encouragement of critical and analytical thinking

During the Enlightenment, scholars were encouraged to think critically and analytically about society. This means they were motivated to question existing beliefs, examine social institutions carefully, and search for logical explanations for social phenomena.

Before the Enlightenment, most social practices and institutions such as family, religion, monarchy, and social hierarchy were accepted without much questioning because they were considered traditional or divinely ordained. People rarely analysed whether these institutions were rational, just, or beneficial to society. Enlightenment thinkers challenged this passive acceptance. They encouraged individuals to observe social life, analyse social structures, and evaluate the functioning of social institutions using reason and evidence. Scholars began to examine how institutions like government, religion, economy, and family influence human behaviour and social relationships. This intellectual climate promoted a systematic and analytical study of society, which later became the foundation of sociology. Early sociologists such as Auguste Comte and Émile Durkheim adopted this approach and studied social order, social change, and social institutions in a scientific and organized way.

The Enlightenment encouraged scholars to critically examine and systematically analyse society and its institutions, which helped develop the scientific study of society known as sociology. The Enlightenment played a significant role in the emergence of sociology. By promoting reason, scientific thinking, criticism of traditional authority, belief in social progress, individual rights, and analytical thinking, it created a new intellectual environment. This environment encouraged scholars to study society scientifically and systematically, which ultimately led to the development of sociology as a distinct academic discipline.

1.2 Sociology as a Science: Nature and Importance of Sociology

- 1. The subunit provides an idea about why we include sociology in the category of science.**
- 2. The subunit also caters an idea about certain basic characteristics of sociology.**
- 3. The subunit displays the importance of sociology.**

Sociology is a science of society, which relied on scientific method like observation, experimentation, historical, comparison etc. for study. Observation meaning accurate watching or noting on the basis of existing theories, the independent observation isn't a scientific method. Experimental method is another commonly used scientific method in natural and social sciences; due to the peculiarity of the subject matter of social science, it is difficult to apply the

experimental method in its strict sense. The subject matter of sociology is individual, he has his own freedom, likes and dislikes, feelings etc. Historical analysis and comparison are the two other scientific methods commonly used in science; these are also applied in sociology for studying its subject matter. Sociology has its own subject matter and the methods of study so we can say sociology is a science. Each and every subject has a specific nature, which simply means the underlying characteristics. Sociology as a branch of knowledge it has its own unique characteristics. It is different from other sciences in certain respects. Robert Bierstedt (1913-1998) an American Sociologist discussed the characteristics of sociology in his well-known book entitled as *The Social Order: An Introduction to Sociology* (1957). Following are the main characteristics of sociology enlisted by Bierstedt

1. Sociology is an independent science

Sociology is not treated and studied as a branch of any other science like philosophy, history etc. and it has its own field of study, boundary and method so it is an independent science.

2. Sociology is a social science not a physical science

Sociology belongs to the category of social science not physical science. As a social science its major attention is on man, social behaviour, social activities and a social life. As a social science Sociology is intimately related to other social sciences like History, Political Science, Economics, Psychology, Anthropology etc. Specifically, Sociology deals with the social universe which distinguishes from Astronomy, Physics, Chemistry and other physical sciences.

3. Sociology is a categorical and not a normative science

Categorical means definite or something stated clearly and firmly. Norms are the expected modes of behaviour based on social values, Sociology studies these norms but not support it. Normative refers to values, judgments, or ideas about what should be or what is considered right or wrong in society. Hence it is categorical but not normative. As science Sociology do not make any kind of value judgments. Sociology is ethically neutral, and never deals with the problems of good and evil, right and wrong. Its approach is neither moral nor immoral but amoral. Sociology deals with values and norms as the 6 bases of social order that constitute social structure. Sociology is a science its knowledge is scientific not emotional.

4. Sociology is a pure science not an applied science

Commonly science is broadly classified into pure and applied. Pure science mainly seeks to the acquisition of knowledge they haven't any application but applied science is mainly concentrates its knowledge more on the application in different contexts than acquisition of knowledge. Sociology is not an applied science.

5. Sociology is relatively an abstract science and not a concrete science

Sociology mainly observes and studies social phenomena, which are abstract in nature. The very subject matter of Sociology is society so it is abstract, whereby Sociology as a discipline studies social relationships, social structure, social system and so on. The subject is more concerned with the forms of human relationships and their pattern, which are absolutely abstract in nature. Because of the nature of the subject matter, the Sociology becomes an abstract science.

6. Sociology is a generalising and not a particularising science

Sociology tries to find out the general laws or principles about human interaction and association about the nature, form, content and structure of human groups and societies. It does not study each and every event that takes place in society in isolation. It tries to make generalizations on the basis of the study of some selected events.

7. Sociology is a general science not a special social science

General science means a branch of knowledge constituted by the combination of different subjects like Economics, Political Science, History, Sociology etc. But special science is the opposite of general science. Special science concentrates its enquiry on specific aspects of knowledge, for example Political Science deals with political aspects of society, Economics deals with the economic aspects of society. Sociology studies human society as a whole in this sense sociology is a general science.

8. Sociology is both a rational and an empirical science

Rationalism and empiricism are the two broad approaches of scientific knowledge. The empiricists emphasized that the experiences and facts that result from observation and experimentation. Simply they conceptualize that all knowledge is derived from senses that means experiences. Rationalists' stresses on reason and theories that result from the logical inferences. In this way Sociology makes use of the methods of rational and empirical sciences. Therefore, Sociology could be treated as both rational and empirical science. Sociology is a

science so its nature is scientific and above-mentioned features are assuring the scientific nature of the subject.

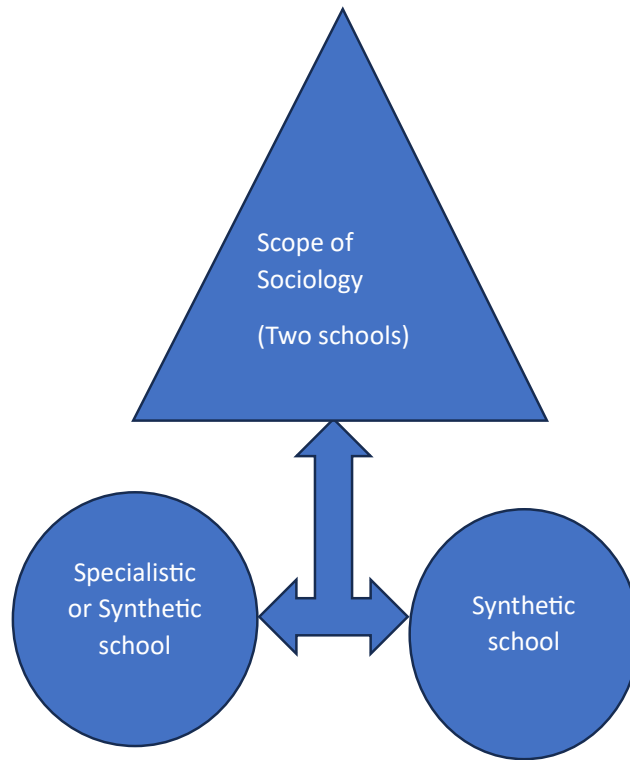
1.3. Scope and Subject matter of Sociology

- **The subunit provides a knowledge about the subject matter of sociology**
- **The subunit also provides a knowledge about the scope and present developments in sociology.**

Subject matter meant that the core content being discussed in a branch of knowledge. Each and every subject have a subject-matter or area of analyses. It is very important to analyse the subject matter of sociology in first module, because it is a primary core course in BA Degree in Sociology. Without making an idea about the subject-matter of a branch of knowledge, it is difficult to study the specific branch of knowledge. So, the analysis of subject-matter of sociology is very important in this part. Society is the subject-matter of sociology, which isn't a single entity. Society is constituted by various components like social institutions, processes, societies, groups etc. anything related with human life. Sociology analyses society's emergence, persistence and changes.

Sociology is a branch of social science which deals with the social aspects like social institutions, social interactions, social behaviour etc. Besides these topics, sociology analyses the economic, political, aspects, which are the landmarks give foundations to social life. Since the dawn of civilization society has been a subject for speculation and enquiry. Even centuries ago, men were thinking about society and how it should be organized. Though, thoughts and discussions were in sociological terms they were called philosophers, historians, thinkers etc. Sociology came to be established as a separate discipline in the 19th century by the efforts of French Philosopher Auguste Comte. But there is no unanimous agreement among the scholars about the scope of sociology, is wide. The scope of a subject mainly determined on the basis of its area of study and the uses of it in people's life. The scope of sociology is widening in accordance with the time changing. When our society developing, various social phenomena, groups, categories, social institutions, social problems, challenges etc. are also developing. So, the scope of sociology becomes widening. Various branches are developed in different periods like, gerontology, medical sociology, Rural and urban sociology, sociology of various marginalised groups, child sociology, sociology of culture, religion, etc. The scope of sociology

explained by philosophers based on separate ideas that constitute two schools of thought such as specialistic or formalistic school and synthetic school, that are briefly explain below.



Specialistic or Formalistic School

It is the first school that explains about the scope of sociology on the basis of the area of study. Certain German Sociologists like Georg Simmel, Alfred Vierkandt, Vonwiese etc. are the main advocates of this school, who opined that, the scope of sociology is limited. The opinion of the sociologists is briefly discussed below:

George Simmel (1858-1918) a prominent German Philosopher and sociologist who headed and who supported the formalistic school's view that sociology is a pure and independent science. He summarized that sociology is a specific science which deals with the forms of social interaction than its content, the content analysed by other social sciences. Sociology deals with the forms of social relationships and activities than the relationships themselves. Alfred Vierkandt (1867-1953) a German Sociologist opined that sociology is a special branch of knowledge which deals with the ultimate forms of mental or psychic relationship which link men to one another in society. Love, hate, cooperation etc. are examples of mental relationships which shape particular type of social relationships. If sociology refrains from the historic study

of concrete societies, Sociology becomes a definite science. Since the subject matter of sociology confined in the forms of mental or psychic relationships the scope of sociology is limited. Leopold Vonwiese (1876-1969) another German Sociologist included in formalistic school who opined that owing to sociology confined its' area of study on the forms of social relationships and social processes the scope of sociology is limited. He divided the social relationships and social processes into different types. According to him there are two social processes in society such as associative and dissociative. Cooperation, accommodation, assimilation are important associative social process whereas competition and conflict are the commonly exist as forms of dissociative social process. Max Weber (1864-1920), a well-known German Sociologist supports the view of formalistic school that the scope of sociology is very limited. Because of sociology concentrates its area of analysis on the interpretative understanding of social action and social behaviour, sociology should confine itself in the analysis and classification of social action and social behaviour. Ferdinand Tonnies a popular German Sociologist opines that sociology studies the forms of social relationship and it deeply analyses all process, phenomena and institutions under the head of the forms of social relationships. Gemeinschaft (German word meaning society) and Gessellschaft (German Word means community) is the differentiation of social group made by Tonnies.

Synthetic School

It is another perception of philosophers on the scope of sociology which was based on the area of study. This school developed as a criticism of specialistic school. The formalistic school opined, that the scope of sociology is wide. Like its name, the school of thought states that sociology is the synthesis of social sciences. Besides this, the school argued, that sociology is a general science. Important thinkers come under synthetic school are L T Hobhouse, P A Sorokin, Morris Ginsberg and Karl Mannheim etc. their contributions are summed up below. Leonard Trelawny Hobhouse (1864-1929) an English liberal political theorist and sociologist, popularly known as Hobhouse who opined that sociology is the synthesis of social sciences but sociologists have some special tasks which are given below. (1) One must pursue his studies in his particular part of the social field. (2) Keeping in mind the interconnections of social relations one should try to interconnect the result arrived at by different social sciences. (3) Sociologists should interpret social life as a whole. Pitirim Alexandrovich Sorokin (1889-1968) a Russian born American sociologist, popularly known as P A Sorokin opines that sociology studies different aspects of social relationship so cannot call it as special science. According to him the area of study of sociology includes 9 the study of general features of social phenomena

and their relationship with various aspects of social phenomena and study the relationship between social and non-social aspects. Morris Ginsberg (1889-1970) a British sociologist, according to him sociology studies and classifies all forms of social relationships, it also analyses the relationship between individual and society. He divides the area of study of sociology into three which constitutes the scope of sociology which are given below

1. Social Morphology
2. Social control
3. Social process
4. Social pathology

Social morphology studies the quality and quantity of population, social groups, social structure and social institutions. Another area of study social control analyses formal and informal control mechanisms existing in society for control the behaviours of members. Social process is the third branch of area of study it studies different types of interaction like cooperation, competition and conflict. Social pathology studies the social problems such as poverty, crime etc. Karl Mannheim (1893-1947) a well knew German Sociologist, who divides the area of study of sociology into two branches. Among those first branch is systematic and general sociology and the second is historical sociology. The first branch deals with the main factors of living together and the second branch studies the historical variety and actuality of the general forms of society. Comparative sociology and social dynamics are the two sections constituted the historical sociology.

Importance of sociology

The importance of a subject refers to its value and usefulness in our daily life. The importance of sociology means the value and usefulness of studying society in a scientific manner. It explains how sociology helps us understand social relationships, social institutions, and social problems in society. Following are the points to prove the importance of sociology:

- **Sociology studies society in a scientific way:** Before the emergence of sociology, there was no systematic and scientific attempt to study human society in all its complexities. Sociology made it possible to study society in a scientific manner. This scientific knowledge about human society is necessary for achieving progress in different fields.

- **Sociology throws more light on the social nature of man:** The social nature of man means that human beings are naturally social and cannot live alone. People depend on others for survival, development, and satisfaction of their needs. Humans live in groups, form relationships, follow social norms, and participate in institutions such as family, education, religion, and the economy. Sociology helps us understand that humans are social beings. It studies how individuals interact with others and how social relationships are formed in society. Sociology explains the importance of social groups, culture, norms, and institutions in shaping human behaviour. Through the scientific study of society, sociology shows that an individual's personality, values, and actions are largely influenced by social interactions and social environment.
- **Sociology improves our understanding of society and increased the power of social action:** Sociology studies social life, social institutions, and social relationships in a scientific way. This scientific knowledge helps people understand the causes of social problems such as poverty, unemployment, crime, and inequality. When the causes of these problems are clearly understood, it becomes easier to take proper social actions and develop effective solutions. Sociological knowledge is also useful for policy making, social planning, and social reforms. Governments, social workers, and organizations can use sociological knowledge to design better programmes and policies for social welfare and development. Thus, sociology increases the power of social action by providing scientific knowledge about society. Increases the power of social action means improving the ability of individuals, groups, or governments to take effective actions to solve social problems and improve society. When people clearly understand how society works, they can take better and more informed decisions in social matters. The study of sociology helps us to know not only our society and men but also others such as motives, aspirations, status, occupations, traditions, customs, institutions and culture: The study of sociology helps us understand not only our own society and people but also other aspects of social life. It helps us learn about people's motives, aspirations, status, occupations, traditions, customs, social institutions, and culture. Through this knowledge, sociology provides a deeper understanding of human behaviour and social relationships in society.
- **The contribution of sociology is not less significant in enriching culture:** An individual's life is shaped by religion, customs, mores, institutions, values, and ideologies. Sometimes these institutions provide emotional or traditional knowledge. However, sociology trains individuals to approach these aspects in a rational and

scientific manner. This rational knowledge helps people overcome prejudices, misconceptions, egoistic attitudes, and class and religious hatred.

➤ **The study of sociology is greater especially in underdeveloped countries:**

Underdeveloped countries are nations that have low levels of economic development, low income, limited industrialization, and poor living standards. These countries often face problems such as poverty, unemployment, illiteracy, and lack of proper infrastructure. Sociological knowledge helps to understand the social conditions and social structures of a society when planning economic development. It studies social aspects such as culture, traditions, social institutions, social values, and social relationships, which influence economic activities. By understanding these social factors, planners and policymakers can design development programs that suit the social realities of the society. This helps in implementing economic plans more effectively and promotes balanced social and economic development. Sociology is an important subject because it studies society in a scientific and systematic way. It helps us understand the social nature of human beings, social relationships, and social institutions. Through sociological knowledge, people can better understand the causes of various social problems and take effective social actions to solve them. Sociology also helps individuals gain a deeper understanding of human behaviour, culture, traditions, and social values. It promotes rational thinking and helps people overcome prejudices and misconceptions. Moreover, sociological knowledge is useful for policy making, social planning, and social development, especially in underdeveloped countries.

➤ **Aware about the importance in solving social problems:** The present world is faced with several serious social problems such as caste-related issues like untouchability, poverty, unemployment, family disorganization, community disorganization, youth unrest, drug addiction, juvenile delinquency, crime, and sexual exploitation. Sociology provides detailed knowledge about individuals, their social life, and their behaviour. This knowledge helps in understanding and solving various social problems more effectively.

➤ **Helps in understanding and planning of society:** Planning of society refers to the systematic and organized efforts to improve social conditions and promote the welfare of people. It involves making plans and policies to solve social problems and to achieve social and economic development. Planning is important because it helps in the proper use of resources and the balanced development of society. It also helps to reduce social

problems such as poverty, unemployment, and inequality and improves the living standards of people. Sociology provides scientific knowledge about social life, social institutions, and social relationships. This knowledge helps planners and policymakers understand the needs, problems, and social conditions of people. By understanding these social factors, effective plans and policies can be developed for the better development and welfare of society.

- **The practical utility of sociological techniques:** Sociological techniques refer to the scientific methods and tools used by sociologists to study society, social behaviour, and social problems. These techniques help in collecting and analysing information about social life in a systematic way. Sociogram, sociometry and social survey etc. are important sociological techniques. Sociogram is a diagram that shows the relationships and interactions among members of a group. The helps to understand group relationships and social networks, useful in schools to study friendships and group dynamics among students and helps teachers or leaders identify isolated individuals or group leaders. Social survey is a systematic method of collecting information about social conditions, opinions, and problems from a large number of people. Social survey helps to understand social problems such as poverty, unemployment, and illiteracy. It provides data for government planning and policy making. Social survey is Useful for social research and welfare programmes. Sociometry is another sociological technic, that is used to measure social relationships and the level of acceptance or rejection among members of a group. Sociometry helps to study group behaviour and social interactions, it is useful in schools, workplaces, and organizations to improve group cooperation. That helps in solving conflicts and improving group relationships.
- **To promote the welfare of tribal people:** Tribal groups are an important area of study in sociology. Many tribal communities are socially and economically marginalized. Sociology studies both the mainstream society and marginalized groups. Through this study, sociologists understand the problems, culture, and living conditions of tribal people. This knowledge helps sociologists and policymakers take effective steps for the welfare and development of tribal communities.
- **Sociology provides categorical knowledge on intrinsic worth and dignity of man:** Intrinsic worth means that every human being has value and dignity by nature, and this value does not depend on external factors such as wealth, occupation, status and social position. Sociology provides clear and systematic knowledge about the intrinsic worth and dignity of human beings. Human beings are not only biological organisms but also

social beings who live and interact in society. Since sociology studies humans as social beings, it helps us understand the value, dignity, and importance of every individual in society.

➤ **Sociology keeps us up-to-date on modern social situations and development:**

Sociology helps us remain aware of modern social conditions and developments. It studies the changes taking place in society, such as changes in culture, technology, economy, and social institutions. By studying these changes, sociology helps individuals understand contemporary social issues and adjust to the changing social environment. Sociology plays an important role in understanding and improving society. It provides scientific knowledge about social life, social relationships, and social institutions. Through this knowledge, sociology helps people understand the causes of various social problems such as poverty, unemployment, crime, and social inequality, and find suitable solutions for them. Sociology also helps in the planning and development of society by guiding policymakers and planners in making effective policies and programmes. Sociological techniques such as sociograms, sociometry, and social surveys help in collecting and analysing information about social conditions. Moreover, sociology promotes social welfare by studying marginalized groups such as tribal communities and by creating awareness about the intrinsic worth and dignity of every human being. It also helps individuals remain aware of modern social changes and developments. Therefore, the study of sociology is very valuable because it contributes to social understanding, social progress, and the overall welfare of society.

Branches of Sociology

- ♠ **The Subunit familiarises various branches of sociology.**
- ♠ **The subunit also caters knowledge about the growing scope of sociology.**
- ♠ **The subunit familiarises learners with the application of sociology in emerging areas of life such as medical, industrial, and rural sectors.**

Sociology is a branch of social science; it is the scientific study of society. It studies the all aspects related with society like evolution, changes, components etc. of society. Its subject matter is not confined in the study of society, in accordance with time changing the study of society is expanding to various fields like religion, culture, health and diseases, industry, rural and urban society, technology, communication, food culture, sports, arts etc. In this section discusses various branches of sociology like Medical, Rural, Industrial etc.

Rural sociology

India was once a country dominated by rural society. People lived mainly in villages, and agriculture was the main occupation. However, with major historical events like the Industrial Revolution and the French Revolution, society began to change, From rural to urban and from agricultural to industrial. Despite these changes, studying rural society is still very important because villages represent the early stage of social development and are the starting point of community life. Rural Sociology as a formal branch of sociology originated in the United States of America (USA) in the early 20th century. It developed to study the social problems and changes in rural areas, especially caused by industrialization and urbanization. The father of Rural Sociology is Louis F. Ward (1878–1950), an American sociologist. He was a pioneer in applying sociological methods to study village life and rural communities. Ward believed that rural society needed to be studied separately because villages had unique social structures, customs, and problems. Rural Sociology studies the social life and relationships in villages. Its main areas are: Rural Community Life, that consists Village organization, customs, traditions, and festivals. Agricultural Systems is another area of analysis, that consists – Farming methods, land use, and economic activities. Social Institutions in Villages is another area of analysis, which includes– Family, caste, religion, education, and local governance. Rural Problems consist – Poverty, illiteracy, unemployment, migration, health issues, and challenges of development. Social Change in Rural Areas – consist Effects of modernization, urbanization, and government policies on village life. Louis F. Ward defines Rural Sociology is the study of social life, relationships, institutions, and problems in rural areas.” In simple words, it is the application of sociology to understand the life, culture, and development needs of villages and rural communities.

Medical sociology

Medical Sociology is the study of social aspects of health, illness, and healthcare. It examines how society, culture, and social institutions influence health, the experience of illness, and the organization of healthcare. Health is not just physical well-being; it is also influenced by social conditions such as Health and Illness in Society – through which Understanding how society defines health and disease. Social Causes of Illness – Factors like poverty, lifestyle, stress, environment, and social inequality. Healthcare Systems – Hospitals, clinics, policies, and accessibility of medical services. Doctor-Patient Relationships – Roles, communication, expectations, and social interaction in medical care. Sick Role – Behaviour expected from

patients and society's response to illness. Medical Profession – Social organization, ethics, and behaviour of doctors, nurses, and health workers. Health Policies and Social Change – How government policies and social developments affect public health. Medical Sociology bridges sociology and medicine by studying health, illness, and healthcare from a social perspective. Illness is not only a biological problem but also a social experience. Social aspects of illness include: Perception of illness – Different societies have different ideas of what counts as sick. Social stigma – Certain illnesses (e.g., HIV/AIDS, mental illness) may lead to discrimination. Family and community response – Support systems or isolation affect recovery. Role disruption – Being sick changes social roles (student, worker, parent) and responsibilities. Cultural beliefs and practices – Traditional healing, rituals, or alternative medicine may influence treatment. Healthcare is shaped by social structures and policies. Social aspects of healthcare include: Access to medical services – Urban vs. rural differences, affordability, and insurance coverage. Doctor-patient relationship – Social norms, communication, and trust between health providers and patients. Organization of health institutions – Hospitals, clinics, and public health systems are influenced by government policies and social needs. Health inequalities – Social class, caste, gender, and ethnicity can determine who gets better or worse care. Public health measures – Vaccination, sanitation programs, and health awareness campaigns reflect societal priorities. Medical Sociology studies how social, economic, cultural, and environmental factors affect health, how people experience illness, and how society organizes healthcare.

The father of Medical Sociology is considered to be Talcott Parsons (1902–1979), an American sociologist. He introduced the concept of “sick role”, in his prominent work namely ‘The Social System’ the book was published in 1951, The book explains how society expects people to behave when they are ill. Parsons emphasized that illness is not only a biological condition but also a social phenomenon with rules, rights, and responsibilities. Medical Sociology originated in the United States of America (USA) in the mid-20th century. It developed as sociologists began to study how social factors like family, community, class, and culture affect health and illness. Medical Sociology studies the social dimensions of health and illness. Its main areas include: Health and Illness in Society, Social Causes of Illness, Healthcare Systems, Doctor-Patient Relationships, Sick Role, Medical Profession, Health Policies and Social Change. Health and Illness in Society is the area of analysis, that includes the Understanding how society defines health and disease. Social Causes of Illness is another area of analysis of medical sociology which includes factors like poverty, lifestyle, stress, environment, and social inequality. Healthcare Systems are another component discusses in medical sociology, it

includes Hospitals, clinics, policies, and accessibility of medical services. Doctor-Patient Relationships is another area of analysis. It includes Roles, communication, expectations, and social interaction in medical care. Sick Role is another area of analysis, that consists, Behaviour expected from patients and society's response to illness. Medical Profession is another content discusses in medical sociology, which constituted by social organization, ethics, and behaviour of doctors, nurses, and health workers. Health Policies and Social Change is another major area of analysis in medical sociology, which deals with How government policies and social developments affect public health.

Industrial sociology

Industrial sociology is the branch of sociology that studies social relationships, interactions, and structures in industrial and workplace settings. It examines how work, industry, and organizations affect human behaviour, relationships, and society. Essentially, it looks at the social aspects of work and industrial life, not just the technical or economic side. It studies how people behave in industries, factories, and organizations, and how work affects society and vice versa. Industrial sociology originated in Europe, particularly in France, Germany, and the UK during the late 19th and early 20th centuries, as industrialization and factory work became widespread. Guy Alchian and Friedrich Engels contributed, but Ferdinand Tönnies and Robert F. Dubin are often mentioned in its early development. Ferdinand Tönnies (1855–1936) studied community and industrial society relationships. In many texts, Robert F. Dubin (1919–1997) is cited for later formal studies in industrial sociology. Father of Industrial Sociology considered as Ferdinand Tönnies. Industrial sociology studies the social relationships, behaviour, and structures in industrial and work settings, focusing on how work affects people and society, that consists the areas such as Industrial Organization and structure, work relationship, labour and work force issues, social impact of industrialisation, industrial culture and behaviour and conflict and cooperation. Industrial Organization and Structure is one of the areas on industrial sociology, that consists How factories, offices, and organizations are organized; hierarchy and management. Work Relationships, another area of analysis which constituted by Relationships between employers and employees, and among co-workers. Labor and Workforce Issues – Employment, labour unions, strikes, wages, working conditions, and job satisfaction. Social Impact of Industrialization is another area of analysis, which constituted by the topics such as How industrial growth affects family life, communities, migration, urbanization, and social change. Industrial Culture and Behaviour is another area of analysing in Industrial sociology, which deals with Attitudes, motivation, discipline, social norms, and

behaviour patterns in the workplace. Conflict and Cooperation in another area of analysing in industrial sociology, which covers the Study of industrial conflicts, negotiation, teamwork, and collaboration in workplaces. Basically, it looks at both the human and social side of industrial life.

Sociology is the scientific study of society, exploring how different parts of society—such as individuals, social institutions, roles, and rules—interact with each other. To study society in depth, sociology has developed specialized branches, including Rural Sociology, Medical Sociology, and Industrial Sociology.

Rural Sociology focuses on village life, social structures, agricultural practices, and rural problems. It helps us understand the social and developmental needs of rural communities. Louis F. Ward, an American sociologist, is considered the father of Rural Sociology. Medical Sociology examines health, illness, healthcare systems, and the social factors that influence them. It emphasizes that illness is not only a biological condition but also a social experience. Talcott Parsons, an American sociologist, introduced the concept of the “sick role” and is regarded as the father of Medical Sociology. Industrial Sociology studies workplaces, industries, labour relations, organizational structures, and the social impact of industrialization. It highlights how work and industrial life affect human behaviour and society. Ferdinand Tönnies, a German sociologist, is considered the father of Industrial Sociology. In essence, these branches show that sociology is not just about society in general, but also about understanding specific social contexts—rural, medical, and industrial—to improve human life and social organization.

Application of Sociology

- 1. The subunit provides an idea about sociology not merely a pure science, it has applications in society.**
- 2. The subunit explains the relevance of sociology in highly complex societies, particularly in the context of the growing influence of capitalism and globalisation.**

Application simply means the practical use of sociology in daily life, or its usefulness and relevance to society. In the earlier part, we discussed that sociology is primarily a pure science rather than an applied science. A pure science focuses mainly on the production of knowledge, rather than its practical application. However, every subject also has an application side. When compared to subjects like economics, statistics, biology, or physics, sociology is less

immediately practical in everyday life. Applying sociological knowledge directly to real social situations can be challenging. Over time, however, the application of sociology has increased, and applied sociology has become more relevant and useful in society. In the next section, we will discuss the application of sociology in detail.

Sociology can be applied in all areas of life. In this section, we will focus on its application in certain fields, including personal life, social planning and public policy, social work and community development, business and industry, health and medicine, crime and justice, education and social research, as well as urban and rural planning.

The application of sociology in personal life

Sociology helps us understand ourselves and our relationships with others. By studying social norms, values, culture, and human behaviour, sociology helps us to understand Relationships: Improve family, friendship, and workplace relationships by knowing how people behave in society. Sociology applies in Decision Making: Make better personal choices regarding education, career, marriage, and social interactions. Sociological knowledge helps to adapt to society: Understand social expectations, traditions, and rules, which helps in adjusting to different social situations. Sociology can apply in self-Development: Become aware of our strengths, weaknesses, and social responsibilities. Sociology helps individuals lead a balanced and socially responsible life by understanding themselves and others.

The application of sociology in public policy and social planning

Sociology helps government and policymakers understand the needs, behaviour, and problems of people in society. By studying social patterns, population, culture, and community life, sociologists provide data and insights that help in: Designing public services like transportation, housing, and sanitation, planning urban areas, parks, and recreational facilities, creating programs that address social issues such as poverty, unemployment, or health care. Sociology ensures that public planning meets the real needs of people and improves the quality of life. Social planning focuses on improving social welfare and addressing social problems. Sociology helps by Identifying social issues like child labour, illiteracy, or gender inequality, suggesting strategies to solve these problems through education, health programs, or community services, evaluating the effectiveness of social policies and programs. Social

planning uses sociological knowledge to make society more organized, equitable, and supportive for all its members.

Application of sociology in social work and community development

Sociology helps social workers understand the social environment, behaviour, and needs of people. This knowledge allows them to Identify problems like poverty, family issues, or addiction, Provide better guidance and support to individuals and families and Design programs for rehabilitation, welfare, and social assistance. For Example: A social worker helping a family overcome unemployment can use sociological knowledge about job markets, education, and social support systems.

Community development aims to improve living conditions and empower people in a community. Sociology contributes by studying community structure, culture, and social relationships, planning projects like health programs, education, or clean water initiatives based on community needs and encouraging participation, cooperation, and social cohesion among community members. For Example: While developing a village, sociologists may assess local problems, traditions, and resources to create programs that the community can use and sustain.

Sociology, though primarily a pure science, has important practical applications in everyday life. Its knowledge helps individuals improve personal relationships, make better decisions, and develop socially responsible behaviour. At the societal level, sociology guides public policy, social planning, social work, and community development to solve social problems and improve the quality of life. By applying sociological insights, society becomes more organized, equitable, and supportive for all its members.

The application of sociology in business and industry

The application of sociology in business and industry refers to the use of sociological knowledge, theories, and research methods to understand and improve relationships, behaviour, and organization within workplaces and industrial settings. It is mainly studied under Industrial Sociology or Sociology of Work, which analyses how social relations influence production, management, and workers' lives. One of the most important applications of sociology in business and industry is improving the relationship between employers and employees. Following are the areas applying sociology in the field of business and industry:

Sociology studies human behaviour, social interaction, and group dynamics in the workplace: Through this knowledge, management can better understand workers' attitudes, motivations, and expectations. For example: Understanding workers' social background helps management create fair policies.

Sociological knowledge helps reduce conflicts, strikes, and misunderstandings between labour and management: It encourages cooperation and mutual respect in the workplace. Thus, sociology helps create harmonious industrial relations.

Sociological knowledge helps to Understand Workers' Behaviour: Workers are not only economic beings but also social beings influenced by culture, family, group norms, and social values. Sociology helps industries understand Worker motivation, Job satisfaction, Attitudes toward work and Informal group behaviour in workplaces. For instance, sociological studies show that informal groups among workers strongly influence productivity and morale. Understanding these social groups helps management design better workplace environments.

Sociological knowledge helps in Solving Industrial Problems: Industrial organizations often face problems such as labour disputes, strikes and lockouts, worker dissatisfaction, absenteeism and labour turnover. Sociology studies the social causes of these problems. By understanding these causes, management and policymakers can develop effective solutions. For example, sociological studies help identify whether problems arise from poor leadership, lack of communication, inequality, or unfair policies.

Sociology helps in Personnel Management and Human Resource Development: Sociology plays an important role in personnel management (human resource management). It helps in recruitment and selection of employees, training and skill development, leadership development and performance evaluation, understanding social factors such as group behaviour, social status, and organizational culture helps HR managers manage employees more effectively.

Sociology helps in Understanding Organizational Structure: Businesses are social organizations consisting of individuals, groups, and hierarchies. Sociology studies Formal and informal organizational structures, Authority and leadership patterns, Communication networks, Organizational culture. A formal organizational structure refers to the officially designed system of roles, responsibilities, authority, and communication within an industry or organization. It is clearly defined by rules, regulations, and hierarchy, and it guides how work is to be performed and managed. An informal organizational structure refers to the unofficial

and personal relationships that develop among workers in an industry. It is not planned or defined by rules but arises naturally through social interactions, friendships, and shared interests among employees. This knowledge helps managers design efficient organizational structures and maintain better coordination among different departments.

Sociology helps in Promoting Worker Welfare: Sociology emphasizes the welfare and well-being of workers. Sociological studies help industries introduce welfare measures such as health and safety programs, social security benefits, housing and recreational facilities and work–life balance policies. These measures improve workers' morale, loyalty, and job satisfaction.

Sociological study Understanding Social Change in Industry: Industrial organizations operate within a broader society that is constantly changing. Sociology helps businesses understand Technological changes, Cultural changes, Urbanization and globalization and Changing work values of employees. By understanding these changes, businesses can adapt their strategies and policies accordingly.

Sociology also helps in understanding Market and Consumer Behaviour: Sociology also helps businesses understand consumer behaviour. People's purchasing decisions are influenced by: Social class, Culture and traditions, Family influence and Reference groups. By studying these social factors, businesses can design better marketing strategies and products that suit the needs of society. The application of sociology in business and industry helps organizations understand human behaviour, improve industrial relations, solve workplace problems, and promote worker welfare. By applying sociological knowledge, industries can create efficient, cooperative, and socially responsible organizations, which ultimately contribute to both economic development and social well-being.

The application of sociology in business and industry is highly significant as it helps in understanding human behaviour, social relationships, and organizational dynamics within the workplace. It improves industrial relations, increases productivity, and helps in solving various industrial problems. Moreover, sociology supports effective personnel management, promotes worker welfare, and enables organizations to adapt to social change. Thus, the use of sociological knowledge contributes to the development of efficient, harmonious, and socially responsible industrial organizations.

Application of sociology in Health and medicine

The application of sociology in health and medicine helps us understand that health is not only a biological condition but also a social phenomenon. By studying social factors affecting health, sociology contributes to better healthcare systems, effective medical policies, and improved public health.

In the field of health and medicine, sociology is applied in various areas such as understanding the social causes of disease, the study of health behaviour, the doctor–patient relationship, the organization of healthcare systems, health policy and planning, the study of public health problems, and improving health awareness.

Understanding the social causes of disease: Sociology helps to identify how social conditions influence health and illness. Health problems are not only biological but also social. Poverty, poor housing, and lack of sanitation increase the risk of disease. Malnutrition and lack of education affect health conditions. Social inequality leads to unequal access to healthcare. For example, people living in poor communities may suffer more from infectious diseases due to overcrowding and poor sanitation.

Sociology helps in study of health behaviour: Sociology studies how people’s behaviour and cultural beliefs affect health practices. Some communities rely on traditional medicine. Cultural beliefs influence diet, hygiene, and treatment choices. Social norms influence habits such as smoking, alcohol consumption, or exercise. Understanding these behaviours helps doctors and health workers design better health programs.

Understand the interaction between doctor patient relationship: Medical sociology studies the interaction between doctors and patients. The sociologist Talcott Parsons introduced the concept of the “Sick Role” in the book *The Social System*. According to this concept a sick person is temporarily exempt from normal social roles, the sick person is expected to try to recover, the patient should seek medical help and cooperate with doctors, this concept helps explain expectations and responsibilities in healthcare.

The organization of healthcare systems: Sociology studies the structure and functioning of hospitals and health institutions. Hospitals are social organizations with Doctors, Nurses, Administrators, Technicians and Patients. Sociology analyses how these roles interact and how healthcare services are organized and delivered.

Health policy and planning: Sociological knowledge helps governments develop effective health policies and programs. For example: Vaccination campaigns, Maternal and child health

programs, public health awareness programs and Disease prevention strategies. Understanding social conditions helps policymakers design programs suitable for different communities.

Study of Public Health Problems: Sociology helps to understand major social health problems such as Poverty and malnutrition, Drug addiction, Mental illness and HIV/AIDS and other communicable diseases. Sociologists analyse how these problems are connected with social structure and social behaviour.

Improving Health Awareness: Sociology helps to promote health education and awareness in society. Through sociological research: Health campaigns can be designed according to cultural beliefs, communities can be educated about hygiene, nutrition, and disease prevention and public participation in health programs can be increased.

The application of sociology in health and medicine is very important as it helps in understanding health and illness as social phenomena. It enables the study of social causes of disease, health behaviour, and doctor–patient relationships. Sociology also contributes to the effective organization of healthcare systems, health policy and planning, and the analysis of public health problems. Furthermore, it plays a key role in improving health awareness among people. Thus, sociological knowledge helps in creating better healthcare systems and improving the overall health and well-being of society.

Application of sociology in crime justice

Sociology helps us understand that crime is a social issue influenced by social conditions. It plays an important role in improving the criminal justice system and in developing effective methods to control and prevent crime. In the field of crime and justice, sociology is applied in various areas, including the understanding of social causes of crime, the study of criminal behaviour, the study of laws and social norms, the functioning of the criminal justice system, the role of punishment and rehabilitation, the study of social problems related to crime, and crime prevention and policy making.

Understanding of social causes of crime: Sociology helps to explain that crime is not only an individual act but also influenced by social conditions. Poverty, unemployment, and inequality can lead to crime, Family disorganization and lack of education may increase criminal behaviour.

The study of criminal behaviour: Sociology studies how individuals become criminals. It examines peer influence, socialization, and environment. It explains why some people engage in deviant behaviour while others do not.

Study of Laws and Social Norms: Sociology helps to understand how laws are created and how they reflect social values. What is considered a crime varies from society to society. Laws change according to social needs and cultural beliefs.

Functioning of the Criminal Justice System: Sociology studies the structure and working of institutions such as Police, Courts, Prisons. It examines how these institutions maintain social order and control crime.

Role of Punishment and Rehabilitation: Sociology helps to analyse different forms of punishment. It studies whether punishment prevents crime. It emphasizes rehabilitation and correction of offenders rather than only punishment.

Social Problems Related to Crime: Sociology examines issues like Juvenile delinquency, Drug addiction and Organized crime. It helps in understanding their social roots and consequences.

Crime Prevention and Policy Making: Sociological knowledge helps in developing effective crime prevention strategies. Government policies can be designed based on social research. Awareness programs and community participation can reduce crime.

The application of sociology in crime and justice is highly significant as it helps in understanding crime as a social phenomenon influenced by various social factors. It explains the causes of criminal behaviour, the role of laws and social norms, and the functioning of the criminal justice system. Sociology also emphasizes rehabilitation, addresses social problems related to crime, and supports effective crime prevention and policy-making. Thus, sociological knowledge contributes to creating a fair, effective, and humane system of justice in society.

Application of sociology in the field of education and social research

Sociology is widely applied in the fields of education and social research. It helps us understand how social factors influence learning, institutions, and the production of knowledge. In the field of education and social research sociology can apply various fields such as Study of Education

as a Social Institution, Understanding Inequality in Education, Teacher–Student Relationship, Role of Education in Social Change, and Curriculum and Cultural Values.

Application of sociology in field of education means studies education as a social institution. Sociology studies education as an important social institution. It examines the role of schools, colleges, and universities in society. It explains how education helps in socialization and cultural transmission.

Understanding Inequality in Education: Sociology analyses how social factors create inequality in education. Class, caste, gender, and religion affect access to education. Some groups have more opportunities than others.

Teacher–Student Relationship: Sociology studies interaction between teachers and students. It helps improve communication and learning methods. It also explains how expectations and behaviour affect performance.

Role of Education in Social Change: Social change means changes in social relationships, institutions, values, norms, and patterns of behaviour in a society. Education plays a key role in social development. It promotes modernization and social mobility. It helps reduce social problems like poverty and discrimination.

Curriculum and Cultural Values: Curriculum refers to the subjects, lessons, and learning experiences that are designed and taught in educational institutions. Sociology studies what is taught in schools. Curriculum reflects the culture, values, and norms of society. It also helps in shaping attitudes and behaviour of students.

The application of sociology in the fields of education and social research is very significant. It helps in understanding education as a social institution, analysing inequalities in education, and improving teacher–student relationships. Sociology also highlights the role of education in promoting social change and examines how curriculum reflects cultural values. Thus, sociological knowledge contributes to creating an inclusive, effective, and socially relevant educational system and strengthens the process of social research.

Application of sociology in social research: Social research refers to the careful collection, analysis, and interpretation of data about social life, behaviour, and relationships. Society is characterized by various complex social problems such as caste issues and the problems faced by marginalized groups. Therefore, it is essential to conduct social research to understand the depth of these issues and to find appropriate solutions. Thus, the relevance of social research

is increasing in contemporary society. The applications of sociology in the field of social research include the use of scientific methods, the understanding of social problems, policy making and planning, data analysis and interpretation, and the evaluation of social programs.

Use of scientific methods: Sociology applies scientific methods to study society, such as Observation, Survey, Interview and Case study. These methods help in collecting reliable data.

Understanding of social problems: Social research helps to study problems like Poverty, Unemployment, Crime and Illiteracy. It provides data for better understanding and solutions.

Policy making and planning: Sociological research helps governments and organizations. It provides information for making policies. It helps in planning development programs.

Data analysis and interpretation: Sociology helps in analysing social data. It identifies patterns and relationships in society. It helps in drawing meaningful conclusions.

The evaluation of social programs: Social research evaluates the success of programs. It checks whether policies are effective. It suggests improvements. Sociology in education helps improve teaching, learning, and equality, while in social research it provides scientific knowledge about society. Both fields are important for understanding and solving social problems and promoting development.

The application of sociology in social research is highly important as it provides a scientific and systematic approach to understanding society. It helps in studying social problems, using reliable research methods, and analysing data effectively. Sociology also supports policy making, planning, and the evaluation of social programs. Thus, sociological research contributes to solving social issues and promoting social development, making it essential in contemporary society.

Application of sociology in Urban and rural planning

Urban and rural societies are the two major forms of social organization found in every society. Individuals live within these social settings, each having its own characteristics, structures, and way of life. Therefore, sociological analysis becomes very important to understand the needs, problems, and living conditions of people in both types of societies. Such analysis helps in promoting the welfare and development of individuals by guiding effective planning and policy-making. The application of sociology in urban and rural planning is very important because it helps planners understand human behaviour, social relationships, and community

needs. Sociology ensures that development is not only physical (roads, buildings, infrastructure) but also social, inclusive, and sustainable. In this section includes the application of sociology in urban and rural sociology. Following are the application of sociology in urban planning:

Understanding Social Structure

Slum Development and Rehabilitation

Managing Urban Problems

Community Development

Urban Governance and Participation

Understanding Social Structure: Social structure is the main area of analysis of sociology. Each and every society has a social structure, which is constituted by individuals, social institutions, social groups, relationships, societies, etc. Sociology studies different social groups such as classes, occupations, migrants, and slum dwellers. This helps planners design cities that accommodate all sections of society.

Urban planning is slum Development and Rehabilitation: Slums are an inevitable part of urban society and often emerge as a result of rapid urbanization. A slum is a densely populated urban area characterized by poor housing conditions, lack of basic facilities such as clean water, sanitation, and proper infrastructure, and a low standard of living. Slum development refers to the process of improving the living conditions in slum areas by providing basic amenities such as safe housing, clean water, sanitation, electricity, education, and healthcare facilities. Rehabilitation of slums means relocating or resettling slum dwellers to better housing with proper facilities, or redeveloping the same area to provide improved living conditions and a healthier environment. Sociological studies help identify the causes of slums such as poverty, migration, and unemployment. Based on this, planners can develop effective housing schemes and rehabilitation programs.

Managing Urban Problems: Social problems are an important area of sociological analysis. Every society faces various social problems, which may sometimes hinder its growth and development. Therefore, a close and systematic study of social problems is very necessary and relevant. In urban areas, cities experience issues such as overcrowding, traffic congestion, unemployment, crime, and pollution. Sociology helps in analysing these problems by studying

human behaviour and social patterns, and it also provides suitable solutions for improving social conditions.

Community Development: Community is a basic concept in sociology. It refers to a group of people living in a specific geographical area who share common social relationships, culture, values, and a sense of belonging. Community development is essential in every society. It is the process of improving the social, economic, and cultural conditions of a community through collective efforts, participation, and planned programs, with the aim of enhancing the quality of life of its members. In urban society, community development is achieved through urban planning. This includes the creation of parks, schools, hospitals, and recreational centers. Sociology helps in understanding the needs of the community and promotes social interaction and overall well-being.

Urban governance and participation: In sociology, governance of society refers to the process and system through which a society is organized, managed, and regulated by institutions, rules, and authority. It includes decision-making, implementation of policies, and maintaining order for the welfare of people. Urban governance refers to the management and administration of cities by government bodies and other institutions to provide services, maintain infrastructure, and ensure the well-being of urban populations. Participation means the active involvement of people in decision-making processes, planning, and implementation of programs that affect their lives and communities. Sociology encourages people's participation in decision-making. It helps in developing democratic and inclusive urban governance systems. Sociology plays a vital role in urban planning by providing a deep understanding of social structure, social problems, and community needs. It helps planners address issues such as slum development and rehabilitation, manage urban problems, and promote community development. Moreover, sociology encourages effective urban governance and active public participation. Thus, the application of sociology ensures that urban planning becomes more inclusive, scientific, and oriented towards the welfare and well-being of all sections of society.

The application of sociology in urban and rural planning is highly significant as it helps in understanding the social structure, needs, and problems of people in both types of societies. In urban planning, sociology assists in managing urban problems, improving slum conditions, promoting community development, and ensuring effective governance and participation.

Application of sociology in Rural Planning: We all know that sociology is the scientific study of society. Rural society refers to a type of society that is located in villages or countryside areas, where people mainly depend on agriculture and related activities for their livelihood, and social life is often shaped by traditions, customs, and close social relationships. Rural planning is the process of developing rural areas through planned efforts to improve agriculture, infrastructure, education, healthcare, and overall living conditions of the rural population. It aims to promote balanced and sustainable development in villages. Rural planning focuses on the development of villages and rural areas. Sociology plays a key role in the following ways: First is Understanding Rural Social Structure, second is Agricultural Development, third is Rural Development Programs, fourth is Addressing Social Inequality and fifth is Promoting Social Change. Then we take a closer look at these points.

Understanding rural social structure: In the previous section, we discussed the meaning of social structure. It refers to the interrelated parts of society, which are constituted by various institutions such as kinship, religion, and traditions. Rural society is shaped by caste, kinship, religion, and traditions. Sociology helps planners understand these factors before implementing development programs.

Agricultural Development: Sociology studies farmers' behaviour, land relations, and rural economy. This helps in planning better agricultural policies and improving productivity.

Rural Development Programs: Government schemes like poverty alleviation, employment generation, and rural housing require sociological insight to ensure proper implementation and acceptance.

Addressing Social Inequality: Inequality refers to the unequal distribution of resources, opportunities, and privileges among individuals or groups in society. It means that some people have more advantages, such as wealth, power, education, or status, while others have less. Sociology helps identify inequalities based on caste, gender, and class. Planning can then focus on uplifting marginalized groups.

Promoting Social Change: Rural areas often resist change due to traditions. Sociology helps introduce new ideas (education, sanitation, health practices) in a culturally sensitive way. Sociology plays a crucial role in rural planning by providing a clear understanding of rural social structure, agricultural practices, and development needs. It helps in the effective implementation of rural development programs, addresses social inequalities, and promotes

positive social change. Thus, the application of sociology ensures that rural planning becomes more inclusive, balanced, and focused on improving the overall quality of life in rural areas.

In rural planning, it helps in understanding rural social structure, improving agriculture, implementing development programs, reducing social inequalities, and promoting social change. Thus, sociological knowledge ensures that both urban and rural planning become inclusive, balanced, and focused on the overall welfare and development of society.

Questions

Multiple choice questions

1. Who is known as the “Father of Sociology”?
 - a) Karl Marx
 - b) Auguste Comte
 - c) Max Weber
 - d) Emile Durkheim
2. According to Emile Durkheim, sociology is the science of:
 - a) Social action
 - b) Social institutions
 - c) Social phenomena
 - d) Social change
3. Max Weber defined sociology as the study of:
 - a) Social institutions
 - b) Social action
 - c) Social structure
 - d) Social groups
4. The Industrial Revolution first occurred in:
 - a) France
 - b) Germany
 - c) United Kingdom
 - d) USA
5. Urbanisation means:
 - a) Growth of villages
 - b) Movement from cities to villages
 - c) Movement from rural to urban areas

- d) Decline of industries
- 6. Who analysed class conflict between bourgeoisie and proletariat?
 - a) Karl Marx
 - b) Max Weber
 - c) Herbert Spencer
 - d) Georg Simmel
- 7. The French Revolution promoted:
 - a) Feudalism
 - b) Slavery
 - c) Liberty, Equality, Fraternity
 - d) Monarchy
- 8. Which concept is associated with Emile Durkheim?
 - a) Class conflict
 - b) Anomie
 - c) Capitalism
 - d) Bureaucracy
- 9. Positivism was developed by:
 - a) Karl Marx
 - b) Auguste Comte
 - c) Max Weber
 - d) Rousseau
- 10. The Renaissance emphasized:
 - a) Religion only
 - b) Humanism and scientific thinking
 - c) Feudalism
 - d) Monarchy
- 11. Sociology uses which method for study?
 - a) Religious method
 - b) Scientific method
 - c) Mythological method
 - d) Philosophical guessing
- 12. Observation in sociology means:

- a) Random watching
- b) Scientific and systematic watching
- c) Guessing facts
- d) Imagining reality

13. Experimental method in sociology is:

- a) Always easy
- b) Impossible
- c) Difficult to apply strictly
- d) Not used

14. Who explained the characteristics of sociology in The Social Order?

- a) Karl Marx
- b) Robert Bierstedt
- c) Max Weber
- d) Auguste Comte

15. Sociology is:

- a) Physical science
- b) Biological science
- c) Social science
- d) Natural science

16. Sociology is a _____ science.

- a) Normative
- b) Categorical
- c) Religious
- d) Moral

17. Sociology is a _____ science.

- a) Applied
- b) Pure
- c) Technical
- d) Practical

18. Sociology studies:

- a) Only individuals
- b) Only groups
- c) Society as a whole
- d) Only economy

19. Sociology is both:

- a) Emotional and religious
- b) Rational and empirical
- c) Moral and ethical
- d) Philosophical and religious

20. Formalistic school believes that sociology has:

- a) Wide scope
- b) Limited scope
- c) No scope
- d) Infinite scope

21. Who is associated with the Formalistic School?

- a) Georg Simmel
- b) Karl Mannheim
- c) Morris Ginsberg
- d) P A Sorokin

22. Synthetic school believes sociology is:

- a) Limited science
- b) General science
- c) Physical science
- d) Experimental science

23. Who divided sociology into systematic and historical?

- a) Karl Mannheim
- b) Max Weber
- c) Herbert Spencer

d) Durkheim

24. Social morphology studies:

- a) Social problems
- b) Population and structure
- c) Social control
- d) Social behaviour

25. Sociology helps in:

- a) Ignoring problems
- b) Solving social problems
- c) Creating conflicts
- d) Avoiding society

Short note

1. Define sociology
2. Renaissance
3. Rationalism
4. Pure science
5. Social pathology
6. Democracy
7. Monarchy
8. Positivism
9. Secularism
10. The course of positive philosophy
11. Estate
12. Individualism
13. Auguste Comte
14. Empiricism
15. Social Morphology
16. Migration

Short Essay

1. What are any two branches of sociology? Discuss them?

2. Define sociology? Explain its scope?
3. Discuss the intellectual forces that led to the development of sociology?
4. Examine whether Sociology can be considered a science?

Essay

1. Define Sociology? Explain the origin and development of sociology as an independent branch of knowledge?
2. What do you mean by Sociology? Examine application of Sociology?
3. Discuss the nature and scope of Sociology?
4. Examine the political forces responsible for the emergence of sociology?
5. Explain the importance of sociology in modern society?